Task - 5

CASE STUDY: PHISHING ATTACK

A scam called phishing fools folks into handing over private data - login codes, account numbers, one-time pins - by acting like someone they trust. These fakes come across email, texts, or web pages built to mirror legitimate services so closely it's hard to tell the difference.

A young man at university goes by the name Rahul. That afternoon, a text arrives - supposedly from his bank - warning access will stop if he does not confirm personal information right away. Appearing legitimate, the provided URL seemed trustworthy enough. Not pausing to question it, he taps the link. A site loads, mirroring his bank’s portal so closely it fools him completely. Into the login page he typed his username, then added the password along with an OTP. Minutes later out went cash from his account - no approval given.

A sneaky message shows up out of nowhere. It pushes you to react fast before thinking twice. A link takes you somewhere that looks real but isn’t. Your details get taken once you type them in. Young people face these traps more often. Online habits make them stand out. They

move quick, trust too soon, skip checking where things come from.

Money vanishes when scams succeed. Accounts get taken over without warning. Personal details end up in the wrong hands. One incident proves it clearly: care matters more than speed. Check every link like your safety depends on it - because it does. Sharing private data opens doors best left shut. Staying alert shapes outcomes most people ignore.

Prevention Checklist:

Stay Safe Online – Checklist:

- Fake helpers might ask for your OTP - don't hand it over. A real bank won't ever need your password. Someone calling and demanding cash access? That's a trap. Trust only what you know yourself. Secrets stay safe when kept silent.
- Start by looking at the web address every time you type in your details. Instead of rushing, take a moment to skip links that seem odd or unfamiliar.
- Start fresh each time with a new password, because repeating old ones risks exposure. Mix letters, numbers, and symbols in ways only you'd think of, yet avoid familiar patterns. One login, one key - keep it tight, keep it separate. Refresh often, before someone else finds their way in.
- Start by turning on two-step verification for key services - email comes first, then move to bank profiles, followed by platforms where you share updates. A second checkpoint here means trouble stays out there.
- When you're on a public network, skip making purchases online or opening private accounts. Sometimes those connections aren't safe, so waiting helps stay secure. A moment of caution keeps your details out of trouble.
- Watch out when grabbing new apps - stick to places you know, such as the main app shops online. Though it seems small, where you download matters more than most think.

UPI safety tips:

- Before hitting send on any UPI transfer, double-check every detail of the recipient's name. Unknown requests should be ignored without exception.
- Got cash coming in? No need for a PIN. Never type your UPI code when someone sends you funds. That step only happens when paying out.

In Case of Cybercrime:

- Report immediately at the **National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- Call the **Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (available 24x7)**